

## Contact

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## Top Skills

Entrepreneurship  
Leadership  
Strategy

## Languages

Spanish

## Certifications

Corporate Governance: Maximize  
Your Effectiveness in the Boardroom

# Jason Preston

VC investor & Co-Founder at Dent -- jason@jrpreston.com  
Seattle, Washington, United States

## Summary

I believe that basically all interesting innovations come from the boundaries between two or more different disciplines. As a Partner at Alsop-Louie I invest in the future of entertainment, social technology, and the relationship between technology and our bodies as we become cyborgs.

I am also the co-founder of Dent, a company that creates and supports a community of entrepreneurs, executives, and creatives who are driven to “put a dent in the universe.” Through my research and work at Dent, I have had the pleasure of spending time with dozens of entrepreneurs and leaders like Pixar co-founder Alvy Ray Smith, Lynda.com founder Lynda Weinman, The North Face founder Hap Klopp, and Indiegogo co-founder Danae Ringelmann.

I care deeply about the challenges that face people with Hydrocephalus. I am a board member for The Hydrocephalus Association, which is the only national nonprofit organization that is funding research into the causes and potential cures for Hydrocephalus on any scale.

Good communication is one of the most essential and most difficult challenges of any human endeavor.

Specialties: Leadership, Culture, Experiential Learning, Public Speaking, Storytelling, Writing, Entrepreneurship, Business development, Strategic analysis, Brand strategy, Event production, Wordpress, CSS, Basic design, Ruby on Rails, Basic Javascript

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## Experience

TK MediaTech Ventures  
Partner  
January 2025 - Present (1 year 1 month)

TK MediaTech Ventures invests in the tech layer of tomorrow's media, entertainment, and games. We are thesis driven: AI is transforming these industries and creating opportunities to build technology companies that will connect our physical world and digital experiences.

### Alsop Louie Partners

6 years 9 months

Partner

April 2022 - Present (3 years 10 months)

### Venture Partner

May 2019 - April 2022 (3 years)

Seattle

### Dent The Future

Co-Founder

January 2012 - Present (14 years 1 month)

Greater Seattle Area

Dent borrows from the Steve Jobs quote "we're here to put a dent in the universe" to rally a community of diverse and motivated entrepreneurs, executives, and creatives. We host an annual flagship conference and several related events and adventures throughout the year that foster connections and collaborations between "Denters" that go beyond our events to create meaningful and lasting change in the world.

### University of Washington

Part Time Lecturer

October 2017 - Present (8 years 4 months)

Greater Seattle Area

Teaching about teamwork and leadership in the Human Centered Design and Engineering (HCDE) department.

### Hydrocephalus Association

Board Member

October 2015 - Present (10 years 4 months)

The Hydrocephalus Association's mission is to eliminate the challenges of hydrocephalus.

### Capture Culture

Founder

January 2019 - January 2022 (3 years 1 month)

## Greater Seattle Area

Getting company culture right comes with tremendous benefits for both the people and the business. I founded Capture Culture to help company leaders capture great values, vision, and behavior as permanent parts of their company culture.

## COFES Institute

### Board Member

April 2017 - April 2018 (1 year 1 month)

Scottsdale, AZ

COFES stands for the Congress On the Future of Engineering Software. The COFES Institute hosts an annual event which draws together the community of people who build, use, and understand the software technologies that power all human engineering.

## Nieman Foundation for Journalism at Harvard

### Nieman Affiliate

September 2015 - June 2016 (10 months)

Cambridge, MA

Nieman Affiliates have access to classes at Harvard and MIT, as well as the ability to participate in most of the fellowship programming, including workshops on public speaking, negotiation, and writing.

- Attended several classes at Harvard University (HBS, HKS, & the College)
- Took the Nieman writing course with Steve Almond. A book agent asked for a book proposal based on my non-fiction essay.
- Participated in negotiation workshop with Brian Mandell
- Deep dive into leadership theory via classes, professors, and the library

## Harvard University Extension School

### Teaching Staff

April 2016 - April 2016 (1 month)

Cambridge, MA

Teaching staff for "Games and Political Philosophy", offered by Christopher Robichaud, PhD. Over this short course we used group and board games to illustrate and teach principles of political philosophy, adaptive leadership, and comfort with failure. Students were asked to reflect on cooperative and competitive game experiences to better understand group dynamics, and to better understand how incentives shape actions.

## Parnassus Group

10 years 7 months

### VP Strategy and Product Development

February 2010 - December 2015 (5 years 11 months)

Redmond, WA

- Helped create innovative social hospitality suite called "Tweet House" at Sundance, SXSW, CES, Comic-Con, & elsewhere
- Sell high-value sponsorships to parties and conferences
- Oversee many aspects of event production
- Make strategic determinations for event positioning, media relationships, business partnerships, and editorial focus

### Director of Marketing

January 2009 - February 2010 (1 year 2 months)

Redmond, WA

- Created world's first Twitter for Business Conference (140tc) with Parnassus Team
- Created innovative social marketing campaigns
- Sourced speakers for conference sessions
- Coordinated Schedule & Details for 140tc Twitter Conference

### Marketing Coordinator

June 2007 - January 2009 (1 year 8 months)

Redmond, WA

- Wrote session descriptions
- PM'd Facebook app to promote 2007 Facebook conference
- Managed conference sessions and schedule
- Marketed conferences via email, facebook, and Twitter
- Created and managed Google ad campaigns

### Intern

June 2005 - May 2007 (2 years)

Redmond, WA

- Wrote blog posts
- Edited conference session descriptions
- Managed email marketing campaigns
- Data entry & Excel handiwork

## Eat Sleep Publish

Producer

May 2008 - 2010 (2 years)

For several years I ran a blog and event series about the future of the publishing industry. The event, called "The Pitch," pioneered a salon-style format in Seattle still in use by other events.

## The Escapist

Writer

September 2006 - April 2007 (8 months)

Los Angeles

I wrote news stories for the Escapist (<http://theescapist.com>).

## Corbis

Internship

July 2004 - September 2004 (3 months)

Data analysis and excel manipulation.

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## Education

### Harvard University

Organizational Leadership · (2015 - 2016)

### Occidental College

Diplomacy and World Affairs, Economics, Business, Politics,  
Philosophy · (2003 - 2007)